



Powering your upgrade

Map your home's power before you automate

Home automation isn't a shopping list. It's a layout problem. In Indian homes, three realities shape everything: switchboards are busy, power is inconsistent (voltage swings, inverter changeovers, occasional outages), and walls are often Wi-Fi-hostile (reinforced concrete, multiple rooms, long corridors). If you don't plan around those, your "smart home" becomes a pile of apps and half-working gadgets.

This chapter is the practical groundwork: how to audit your rooms, decode switchboards, plan hub/router placement, and follow basic safety + BIS/ISI checks so your setup doesn't become an electrical lottery.

Plan first, buy second

Before you buy anything, you should be able to answer:

- **What do I want to automate in each room?** (lights, fan, AC, plugs, sensors)
- **Is this a renter setup or owner setup?** (reversible vs rewiring allowed)
- **What happens during power cuts?** (what stays on inverter/UPS, what doesn't)
- **What's my "control style"?** (voice, phone, automation-only, wall control)